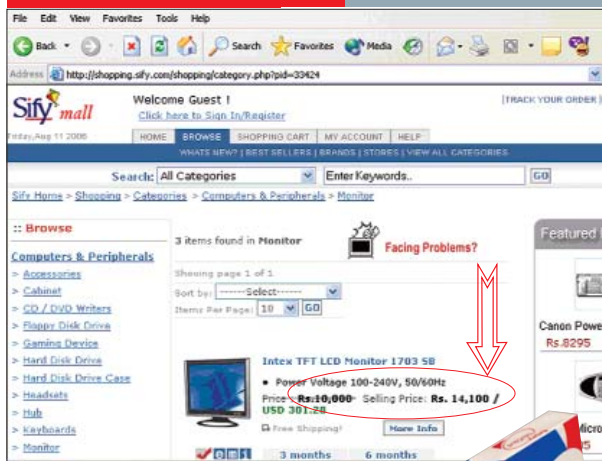


DigiPick of the month

"Monitor or
Money-Eater?"



Last month's
winner is
Vishvas Rajput
Gwalior

Participate and win
next month
Enjoy Thin Client



WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with the subject **'DigiPick'** and your postal address **on or before the 20th of this month** to **digipick@thinkdigit.com**. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

was to open up the machine and take a reading off a mechanical counter. So, the Ellisons (of Mach 5 Products) came up with a digital device that transmits the accounting information via infrared to a laptop or PDA.

Unfortunately for the Ellisons, they named the product the Profit Pod.

Why this preamble, and why is the name unfortunate? Because—to our sheer disbelief—Apple actually seems to think this is an infringement on the iPod name, and sent the Ellisons a threatening letter, telling them to "cease and desist" and discontinue the product, or something to that effect.

The letter itself makes for a fun read:

"We believe there is confusing similarity between Apple's IPOD mark and the PROFIT POD mark. PROFIT POD is a POD-formative mark and incorporates a substantial portion of Apple's IPOD mark. The products are likewise

related. Both devices receive and transmit data and are used with computers, both are used in connection with video games, and both have other similar components. Moreover, it has not gone unnoticed that, like Apple's IPOD device, the PROFIT POD product is a small, flat, round corned rectangular device with a display screen."

Refer the letter above. "Both devices receive and transmit data and are used with computers." That makes for a similarity? The "similarity" may not have gone unnoticed to Apple's lawyers, but it has indeed gone unnoticed to us. The thing doesn't look, smell, feel, or do anything remotely close to what an iPod does. You can't buy it in a store. And most importantly, the Profit Pod has nothing to do with music.

We thought the folks at Apple were nice, friendly guys, thinking different, and generally doing their thing. Not any more: this bit of news makes them seem like

just any other money-grubbing, litigating corporation. And they aren't setting a good precedent, either. At Digit, for example, we're getting tempted to patent ones and zeroes, because we own what are called the Zero1 Awards.

STARTLING NEW FINDINGS

A Girl Loves Her Gadgets

All you married or casually-hitched men out there hate it when The Loved One spends too much time in the shoe section of the department store. Or in the jewellery section. Or in the clothes section. That's the stereotype, and it's changing, according to a survey commissioned by a US cable TV network: it could soon be in the gadgets section that you'll have to do your waiting.

Girls may still prefer dolls and boys may still prefer to take apart toys, but for grown women, diamonds are taking a backseat to plasma TVs and digicams and such. Seventy Seven per cent of the women surveyed said they'd rather get themselves a large plasma TV than a solitaire necklace. And the plasma TV scored even over a weekend getaway to Florida.

Shoes are losing out to silicon, too: 78 per cent of the women surveyed said they'd rather have a new top-of-the-line cell phone than a pair of designer shoes. And shoes also came second to digital cameras and Media Center PCs.

People Who Changed Computing

The Original iMan!

If there was one person who changed the way we listen to music after the advent of the Walkman, it has to be Jonathan Ive. Ive joined



Jonathan Ive

Apple in 1998 as head of design, and revolutionised the way Apple Macs were designed—the computer placed inside

the translucent monitor design. This design is rumoured to have single-handedly boosted the failing fortunes of the company. Ive was born in 1967 in London, and studied art and design at Newcastle Polytechnic in 1985. He co-founded his own design studio, Tangerine, in London in 1990. He used his skills to design everything from bathroom products, combs, power tools, televisions and even ceramics. Soon Apple was one of their clients, and in 1992, Ive moved to Cupertino, California, to join the Apple design team. Apple was struggling with finances, lawsuits and new lines of products being recalled.

Then Ive and his design team brought out the iMac G3, widely regarded as the birth of the new Apple. After the successes of the G3, Jonathan's products have pushed the boundaries of conventional design with simplicity, elegance and innovation. Everything he lays his hands on seems to turn to gold.

Ive is reportedly a very modest, shy person. This was evident when he won the Design & Advertising award, and it was Steve Jobs who went up, collected the award and gave the acceptance speech—this, despite the fact that Ive was present at the event. Mr Ive, all we iPod fanatics salute you!